

Meeting Name:	Overview and Scrutiny
Date:	7 th January 2026
Report title:	Old Kent Road
Ward(s) or groups affected:	All
Classification:	Open
Reason for lateness (if applicable):	
From:	Director of Planning and Growth

RECOMMENDATION(S)

1. OSC note the officer's presentation on progress in the transformation of the Old Kent Road opportunity area.

BACKGROUND INFORMATION

2. Southwark in 2016 started the process to reimagine the OKR through the redesignation of protected industrial sites to deliver a mixed-use neighborhood with an additional 20,000 new homes, the necessary social infrastructure to support such growth and a net increase in jobs.

KEY ISSUES FOR CONSIDERATION

3. The OKR is delivering homes quicker than comparable schemes across London – Old Oak Common/Royal Docks despite those projects receiving significant public funding.
4. The OKR is delivering over 50% affordable housing (on a habitable room basis) with 32% of the habitable rooms being for Social Rent. The OKR contains the councils two largest estate regeneration projects at Tustin and Ledbury Estates. Phase 1 of the Tustin redevelopment has recently been completed and Phase 1 of Ledbury is due to complete mid 2026. Both schemes received the support of residents in a ballot, and residents have been involved in the choice of architects and have helped steer the design and delivery of the new housing.
5. Extensive public engagement on the OKR AAP has been undertaken over the last 9 years with over 100 public consultation events, over 2,000 individual responses. In all 4 drafts of the document were produced in 2016, 2017, 2020

with the final draft in 2025. Over that time in response to engagement meaningful changes were made to the draft plan to increase the amount of park space proposed, increase the amount of light industrial floorspace planned and revise the plans tall building strategy.

6. In 2020 a Community Review Panel was established for the OKR area following feedback from public engagement on the AAP. The panel comprises local residents and business owners with a balanced mix of age, gender and ethnicity. The panel meets every 5-6 weeks to review planning applications as well as the council's own plans and strategies. The panel has proved to be very successful as a way of meaningfully engaging the local community and the feedback received has helped to shape development as it comes forward. The intention is to use this as a model to establish similar CRPs for other areas of the borough.
7. S106 monies have been collected from developers to improve existing public parks and spaces and also to enhance the bus network in advance of the delivery of the BLE. In September 2025 the Bakerloop express bus service began operating along the alignment of the BLE with stops at the proposed new stations. The council contributed £5m in s106 funding to help TfL deliver this service. Cycle and pedestrian provision has also been improved in the area in partnership with TfL with the cycle route 12 from Peckham to Rotherhithe currently under construction on Ilderton Road and School Streets projects funded from community CIL due to be implemented at Phoenix primary school on Rolls Road and John Keats primary school on Verney Road.
8. S106 monies have also been used to deliver enhanced public spaces with £700,000 committed to the regeneration of Bramcote Park (works due to begin on site early in 2026) and £300,000 towards Brimington Park (in addition to the £416,000 secured in community CIL). S106 monies have also been spent on fitting out a consultation and youth hub at 231 Old Kent Road (£150,000). Community CIL monies are paying for the enhancement of Leyton Square (£728,000), Bird in the Bush Park (£312,000) and are also contributing to funding the refurbishment of the Kentish Drovers listed mural (£336,000). In total £2.49m of community CIL is being invested in the OKRD. This is in addition to the £9.6m of funding that the council secured from the Future High Street Fund (FHSF) in 2020, which has been spent on the delivery of projects including the Livesey Exchange Phase 1 and 2 (LEX, community affordable workspace) and the repainting of the railway bridge at the southern end of OKR.
9. FHSF monies have also been used to secure the Folegate site at 721-733 OKR and to retain and refurbish a locally listed building on the site. The current plan is to partner with a house builder to deliver 50% affordable housing as well as a new community health hub in partnership with the NHS.
10. In addition to funding improvements to existing open spaces the AAP also requires developers to deliver new open space within their own sites. An early example of this being the pocket park completed in 2025 on what was the KFC drive through car park. In early 2027 it is anticipated that the first phase

of the Ruby Triangle park will be completed on what was the car park of Carpetright and in late 2027 the first phase of the Surrey Canal Park will be completed by Berkeley Homes on their Malt Street development. The latter will ultimately provide a continuous open space link between Burgess Park and the Old Kent Road.

11. The Area Action Plan was submitted to the Secretary of State November 2025, with an Examination in Public (EIP) likely to take place in September 2026.
12. Delivery of homes in the OKR is split into 2 phases – 9,500 pre BLE funding 10,500 post BLE funding. We have already reached 9,500 cap in terms of approvals of which approximately 2,300 are either built or currently under construction. We are, however, aware that some schemes in phase 1 are technically implemented (Cantium Retail Park) but are unlikely to be delivered until post 2030. The phasing of development is kept under continual review and its likely that some current Phase 2 sites will be moved into phase 1 as their planning consents expire, thereby maintaining the pace of delivery.
13. For all the factors reported to Housing Scrutiny in December 2025 the traditional model of residential development is broken for a host of reasons including the limits on affordable housing grant available and the cost of construction v sale values achievable. This has meant that developers have pivoted to nonstandard residential products which don't carry a sales risk – student and co-living. Uniquely to Southwark our policies require both these products provide traditional affordable homes on site. To date this has helped to sustain the delivery of homes in the OKR and maintained the level of affordable housing on offer to at least 35%. The AAP emphasises that the council will only support student and co-living schemes were they contribute to mixed and inclusive communities and help deliver other key aspect of the plan including on site affordable homes, work space and park space. With this in mind the number and location of student and co-living schemes is kept under review to ensure that the aspiration for mix and inclusivity is not undermined.
14. The AAP promotes the delivery of a DHN and over the last year the pipework has been delivered from SELCHP along Ilderton Road and across the Old Kent Road by Veolia. The DHN will connect to the councils existing estates, including the Tustin, enabling significant CO2 and cost savings as individual existing and inefficient end of life estate communal boilers are turned off. The process was supported by LBS, officers securing government funding with Veolia to scope out the initial business case and then securing a Local Development Order to speed up the planning and consents process.
15. Work on BLE continues in accordance with the program set out in the draft AAP. The TfL BLE project team are fully funded and the Mayor and TfL remain committed to the delivery of the BLE. The technical work required for the Transport and Works Act Order process (in effect the planning application to deliver the BLE) is scheduled to be completed by 2028/29. Work completed in 2025 included the detailed design of the two stations on the OKR and a New Cross Gate and Lewisham which LBS and LB Lewisham each contributed £250,000 (the LBS contribution from strategic CIL). LBS is committed to using 50% of Strategic CIL to help deliver the BLE and it is anticipated this will help

part fund further technical work to support the TWAO in partnership with TfL and LB Lewisham. The total cost of this process to 2028 is estimated to be £28m. The TWAO needs to be in place in order to secure capital funding. To help make the case to government LBS/LBL and TfL updated the BLE funding study in 2025, which sets out a series of options for offsetting the total capital cost by securing contributions from developers and development for its eventual delivery.

16. The council continues actively promote the BLE in partnership with LBL, TfL and Central London Forward. The emphasis being that the BLE is of regional significance to London in terms of the total number of homes and jobs it would be able to create. The BLE campaign includes the use of social media and the Back the Bakerloo web site, attendance and presentations at major industry events including the UK Real Estate Investment Forum and the London Real Estate Investment Forum and of course the Bakerloop Bus, which provides a physical reminder of the BLE project. In addition to this a structured comms strategy was developed for lobbying central government, leveraging in the support of both local MPs and the leaders of boroughs and MPs along the existing Bakerloo Line.

Policy framework implications

17. The OKR AAP is entirely consistent with the adopted Southwark Plan 2022 and its relevant Strategic, Development Management and Site Allocation policies.

Community, equalities (including socio-economic) and health impacts

Community impact statement

Is contained within the supporting documents for the OKR AAP.

Equalities (including socio-economic) impact statement

Is contained within the supporting documents for the OKR AAP.

Health impact statement

Is contained within the supporting documents for the OKR AAP.

18. The Old Kent Road project will have a positive community, equalities and health impact.

Climate change implications

19. Improvements across the OKR will have a positive impact on the environment.

Resource implications

20. Capital N/A

Consultation

21. N/A

BACKGROUND DOCUMENTS

Background Papers	Held At	Contact
Officer Presentation	Planning and Growth	Tim Cutts

APPENDICES

Appendices		
N/A		

AUDIT TRAIL

This section must be included in all reports.

Lead Officer	Stephen Platts		
Report Author	Tim Cutts		
Version	V1		
Dated	30/12/25		
Key Decision?	No		
CONSULTATION WITH OTHER OFFICERS / DIRECTORATES / CABINET MEMBER			
Officer Title		Comments Sought	Comments Included
Assistant Chief Executive, Governance and Assurance		No	No
Strategic Director, Finance		No	No
List other officers here			
Cabinet Member		No	No
Date final report sent to Constitutional Team			6 January 2026

Note: Consultation with other officers

If you have not consulted, or sought comments from the Assistant Chief Executive, Governance and assurance or the Strategic Director of Finance, you must state this in the audit trail.